

Code Reference: .github/workflows/main-branch-gate.yml

A source-level explanation with function details, file communication, variables, endpoints, and debugging notes.

Item	Explanation
File	.github/workflows/main-branch-gate.yml
Purpose	GitHub Actions guard that rejects direct pushes to main and rejects pull requests into main unless the source branch is development.
Lines	40
Size	1,259 bytes
Talks to	GitHub/release layer
Functions	0
Variables/constants	0
API mentions	0
Signals	1

How this file participates in the system

This generated section reads the actual file and points out line numbers, declarations, endpoints, events, source excerpts, and debugging cues.

Important implementation signals

Item	Explanation
Security or auth at line 11	Publishing protection, API key safety, HTTP security, or user authorization. Evidence: permissions:

Representative opening snippet

```
1: name: Main Branch Gate
2:
3: on:
4:   pull_request:
5:     branches:
6:       - main
7:   push:
8:     branches:
9:       - main
10:
11: permissions:
12:   contents: read
13:
14: jobs:
15:   require-development-source:
16:     name: Require development as the main source branch
17:     runs-on: ubuntu-latest
18:
19:     steps:
20:       - name: Verify main only receives development
21:         shell: bash
22:         env:
23:           HEAD_COMMIT_MESSAGE: ${ github.event.head_commit.message }
24:         run: |
25:           if [ "${ github.event_name }" = "push" ]; then
26:             if printf '%s' "$HEAD_COMMIT_MESSAGE" | grep -Eq '^Merge pull request #[0-9]+ from
[^/]+/development$'; then
27:               echo "main was updated by a development release PR."
28:               exit 0
29:             fi
30:
31:             echo "::error::Direct pushes to main are not allowed. Open a pull request from development
into main."
32:             exit 1
33:           fi
34:
35:           if [ "${ github.head_ref }" != "development" ]; then
36:             echo "::error::Pull requests into main must come from development. Merge this branch into
development first, test development, then open the development -> main release pull request."
37:             exit 1
38:           fi
```

```
39:
40:     echo "main release source is development."
```